

MERIDIAN INTELLIGENCE

What it is, where it stands, and how it grows

7 AUGUST 2026
PRIVATE AND
CONFIDENTIAL

WHAT MERIDIAN IS

Meridian is an executive intelligence practice. It takes one high-consequence business decision and returns a written, decision-grade position in days, using seven senior domains run at the same time, with forty years of board-level judgment as the final gate.

You brief it in plain language. It works out every domain the question genuinely touches, runs them **in parallel**, has the work independently checked, and returns one consolidated answer with a status and a record of how it was checked.

The seven domains. Commercial and Deal · Legal and Governance · Finance and Restructuring · Property and Development · AI Strategy and Adoption · Business Transformation and Growth · AI Equity and Investment. **Four carry a mandatory human gate:** nothing in Legal, Finance, Property or AI Equity is acted on without a named person signing it off, and where that person disagrees with the engine, they govern and the disagreement stays in the record.

THE FLOOR UNDER EVERY ANSWER — THE PART THAT MATTERS

- **The grounding rule.** No statute, case, figure, title fact or valuation reaches a client unless it was pulled from its primary source and the passage supports it. Anything from memory is never fact. Every hard fact is tagged VERIFIED, REPORTED or UNVERIFIED, and a citation that will not resolve is held.
- **Two critics.** A verification critic tries to *invalidate* the work against source, briefed from the original question rather than the producer's summary of it. A separate adversarial critic asks where a supportable recommendation could still fail. Independence is established by construction, and where it cannot be, that is stated rather than claimed.
- **A status on everything.** DRAFT, IN REVIEW or DECISION-READY. The last is a ten-point release gate, not a label, and if a piece falls short the system says which point failed.
- **Fail closed.** It holds rather than guesses where a material claim is unverified, where a contradiction could change the recommendation, where a human gate is outstanding, or where the adversarial critic can name a missing fact capable of reversing the answer.
- **The audit record.** Who produced what, from which sources, what the critics found, who gated it and when, and which version of the engine produced it. Every answer can be reconstructed later.
- **The boundary.** Meridian informs, it never represents. Anything binding, signed, filed or relied on goes to a qualified professional first. The legal capability is Irish law; where other law becomes material the system stops and requires qualified input.

Why this is the asset. A tool that gives an answer is common. A tool that gives an answer **and can show exactly how it reached it, and where it refused to guess**, is rare. The floor is not overhead. The floor is the product. **Which means the floor has to be testable.**

WHAT CHANGED THIS WEEK

The engine was documented in full for the first time, extended from **50 skills to 61**, and then put through an external review of its assurance claims. The controls below were tightened as a result.

New capability	Where it sits	What it does
Read-this-for-me	Legal	A contract, lease or term sheet dropped in. What matters, what bites, what to push back on.
Obligations and deadlines	Legal	Every date, statutory clock and filing in one schedule, with the liability flags.
Portfolio conflict check	Legal	Tests an action against existing board seats, shareholdings and mandates before a conflict arises.
Meeting-prep brief	Commercial	One grounded page before any room: who is being met, their position, where the leverage sits.
What-else scan	Transformation	At the close of a matter, the adjacent work the client needs next.
Support and grant scan	Transformation	State supports a client can actually draw on, eligibility checked to source.
Argue-the-other-side	Every answer	Makes the strongest case against the recommendation and names where it would break. Runs unprompted on anything high-stakes.
Say-it-to-the-client	Every answer	Renders technical output as a clean plain-English page, accuracy intact, sources kept.
Prior-decision recall	Every answer	Checks what was already concluded, and whether it is genuinely analogous or merely similar. Silent reversal and silent repetition are both failures.
Change-the-answer test	Every answer	The smallest set of facts or events that would materially reverse the recommendation. How robust the call is, not only what it is.
Evidence gap before advice	Every answer	What is still not known that could affect the decision, stated before the reasoning accelerates.

*The last five sit under no single domain and apply to **every** answer, because a skill wanted everywhere would otherwise fire only when its domain happened to be involved, which is exactly when it is least needed. **Prior-decision recall is the significant one**: it turns past work from an archive into an asset.*

HOW IT GETS BETTER FROM HERE

The engine is extended in plain English, not in code. **1.** Say what you want in one plain sentence. **2.** Decide which domain already thinks that way. **3.** Match the shape of what is already there. **4.** Write the line and save. **5.** Prove it against the five test cases. **6.** Commit it, so it is on the record.

Only the first two steps require judgment. Everything after is mechanical. **Every capability is required to inherit the same grounding, review, status and escalation controls, and that inheritance is validated before the capability is promoted into use.** Each new capability is exercised against an ordinary case, an incomplete-evidence case, a contradictory-source case, a case that must reach a human, and a case it should refuse. **Easy to add is not the same as automatically trusted**, and the system does not claim otherwise.

The working rule: when the same thing has been done by hand twice, that is the next capability. Both additions made this week came from exactly that. Grant intelligence had appeared unprompted in three separate pieces of client work before anyone thought to make it a skill.